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Prepared By: Roswitha Krautgartner

Approved By: Matthew Snyder

Report Highlights:

This report updates several sections of the European Union’s (EU) “Oilseeds and Products Annual” report released in April 2025 (March forecast). Updated sections include soybean, rapeseed, sunflower, and oilseeds policy. Total forecasted production of these three crops is revised down 1 percent compared to the April 2025 annual report, and total area is revised down by almost 5 percent. Higher-than-anticipated yields, particularly for rapeseed, are expected to offset production losses due to lower area. Year-on-year, MY 2025/26 production of these three oilseeds is forecast to rebound to average levels compared to the low production in MY 2024/25.

Executive Summary

More recent available data indicate a downwards revision of major European Union (EU) oilseeds (rapeseed, sunflower, soybeans) area in marketing year (MY) 2025/26 by almost 5 percent compared to the March numbers in the FAS EU oilseeds annual report 2025. This downward revision is largely due to lower than anticipated rapeseed area. While area is revised down, total production of the three oilseeds is forecast to be only down by 1 percent compared to the March estimate but up by about 11 percent compared to MY 2024/25, largely due to better than expected yields in all three major oilseeds. Imports are marginally increased compared to the March forecast. As domestic production recovers, overall imports of oilseed seeds in MY 2025/26 are anticipated to decline by over 5 percent year-on-year.

Crush demand is forecast to remain strong, supported by favorable crush margins and vegetable oil prices with slight upward revisions for soybean and rapeseed crush offsetting a downward revision in sunflower crush. In MY 2025/26, increased crush is forecast for rapeseed and sunflower more than making up for a decline in soybean crush, resulting in a total 3 percent increase year-on-year.

Increased production of sunflower and rapeseed meal is expected to encourage a recovery in feed consumption for these two meals at the expense of soybean meal, with total meal consumption declining year-on-year due to lower demand. Overall meal consumption for animal feed is revised slightly up from the 2025 Annual Report for soybean meal but slightly down for sunflower meal, which results in a 1 percent decline compared to MY 2024/25 and reflects declining demand from a shrinking livestock sector. Higher domestic availability and lower demand from the animal feed sector are expected to result in an 8 percent decline in overall imports of oilseed meals in MY 2025/26 year-on-year with upwards revisions for soybean and sunflower meal imports but downwards revision for rapeseed meal imports.

Higher domestic availability of sunflower oil is anticipated to support its recovery in food use. Compared to the Annual Report, soybean and rapeseed oil food use have been revised up.

Introduction

This report presents the outlook for oilseeds in the EU. The data in this report is based on the views of Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS) analysts in the EU and is not official USDA data.

Disclaimer / Important Notes:

- USDA official numbers in this report include the World Agricultural Supply and Demand Estimates (WASDE) August 2025 release.
- In this report the term "biofuel" includes only biofuels used in the transport sector. Biomass/biofuel used for electricity production or other technical uses such as lubricants or in detergents are included in "industrial use."
- Trade figures are revised according to the most recent data available from Trade Data Monitor (TDM).
- The term European Union (EU) refers to the current [EU27 member states](#).

This report was a group effort of the following FAS analysts:

Bettini, Ornella	FAS/Rome covering Italy
Bolla, Sophie	FAS/USEU Brussels Coordinator Policy Section
Boshnakova, Mila	FAS/Sofia covering Bulgaria Coordinator Sunflower Section
De Belder, Tania	FAS/USEU Brussels covering Belgium and Luxembourg
Dobrescu, Monica	FAS/Bucharest covering Romania
Faniadis, Dimosthenis	FAS/Rome covering Greece
Fischer, Jana	FAS/Prague covering the Czechia and Slovakia
Flach, Bob	FAS/The Hague covering the Netherlands, Sweden, Finland, and Denmark
Galica, Anna	FAS/Warsaw covering Poland, Estonia, Latvia, and Lithuania
Golya, Gellert	FAS/Budapest covering Hungary
Guerrero, Marta	FAS/Madrid covering Spain and Portugal
Krautgartner, Roswitha	FAS/Vienna covering Austria and Slovenia Overall coordinator and coordinator Executive Summary, and Total Oilseeds Section Contribution to Soybean Section
Little, Jonathan	FAS/London covering the Republic of Ireland
Misir, Andreja	FAS/Zagreb covering Croatia
Robu, Alexandra	FAS/Paris covering France Contribution to Soybean Section
von Witzke, Katarina	FAS/Berlin covering Germany Coordinator Rapeseed Section Contribution to Soybean Section

The marketing years used in this report are:

July-June

Rapeseed complex

October -September

Soybean complex

Sunflower complex

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1. Total of Major Oilseeds (Soybean, Rapeseed, Sunflower)

Note: Total oilseeds include different marketing years with different beginning and ending months.

Please find details of the specific commodities in the respective sections.

Table 1: EU Area of Major Oilseeds (in 1,000 HA)

Area	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybeans	948	1,000	1,116	1,013	1,105	1,075
Rapeseed	5,326	5,324	5,887	6,263	5,700	5,690
Sunflower	4,460	4,378	4,900	4,700	4,820	4,780
Total	10,734	10,702	11,903	11,976	11,625	11,545

Note: The years refer to the calendar year in which the harvest occurs (e.g., 2025 = harvested in CY 2025, marketed in MY 2025/26)

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

Table 2: EU Major Oilseeds Production (in 1,000 MT)

Production	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybeans	2,600	2,750	2,608	2,795	2,920	2,990
Rapeseed	16,699	16,945	19,417	20,403	16,935	19,350
Sunflower	8,920	10,288	10,200	10,100	8,750	9,400
Total	28,219	29,983	32,225	33,298	28,605	31,740

Note: The years refer to the calendar year in which the harvest occurs (e.g., 2025 = harvested in CY 2025, marketed in MY 2025/26)

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

Table 3: EU Major Oilseeds Crush (in 1,000 MT)

Crush	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybeans	15,700	15,500	14,300	14,400	15,500	15,200
Rapeseed	22,300	21,700	24,200	24,900	23,350	23,950
Sunflower	8,200	10,300	9,100	9,300	7,800	8,700
Total	46,200	47,500	47,600	48,600	46,650	47,850

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

Table 4: Feed, Waste Use of Major Oilseeds Meals in the EU (in 1,000 MT)

Feed, Waste Use Meals	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybeans	28,000	27,500	26,400	26,750	30,900	28,800
Rapeseed	12,500	12,250	13,500	13,900	13,400	13,500
Sunflower	6,450	7,000	6,900	7,000	6,350	6,500
Total	46,950	46,750	46,800	47,650	50,650	48,800

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

Table 5: Food Use of Major Oilseeds Oils in the EU (in 1,000 MT)

Food Use Oil	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybean Oil	1,200	1,200	1,240	1,270	1,300	1,295
Rapeseed Oil	2,350	2,450	2,900	2,900	2,800	2,800
Sunflower Oil	4,200	4,950	4,850	4,940	4,700	4,850
Total Oils	7,750	8,600	8,990	9,110	8,800	8,945

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

Table 6: Industrial Use of Major Oilseeds Oils in the EU (in 1,000 MT)

Industrial Use Oil	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25e	MY 2025/26f
Soybean Oil	1,100	1,850	1,043	1,460	1,250	1,255
Rapeseed Oil	6,600	6,100	6,975	7,200	6,575	6,750
Sunflower Oil	500	750	500	550	550	550
Total	8,200	8,700	8,518	9,210	8,375	8,555

e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

2. Soybean Complex

PSDs have been revised according to the most recent data available from Trade Data Monitor (April 2025) and Eurostat. Recent harvest and crush estimates are from producing countries.

Soybean Seed

Table 7: Oilseed, Soybean – Production, Supply and Distribution

Oilseed, Soybean Market Year Begins	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
European Union						
Area Planted (1000 HA)	1200	0	1200	0	1200	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	1016	1013	1125	1105	1100	1075
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	1259	1259	1279	982	1880	1102
Production (1000 MT)	2807	2795	2921	2920	2925	2990
MY Imports (1000 MT)	13461	13461	14600	14800	14200	14160
Total Supply (1000 MT)	17527	17515	18800	18702	19005	18252
MY Exports (1000 MT)	253	253	400	400	300	270
Crush (1000 MT)	14500	14400	15000	15500	15300	15200
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	220	200	220	200	220	200
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1275	1680	1300	1500	1300	1550
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	15995	16280	16520	17200	16820	16950
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	1279	982	1880	1102	1885	1032
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	17527	17515	18800	18702	19005	18252
Yield (MT/HA)	2.7628	2.7591	2.5964	2.6425	2.6591	2.7814
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

In comparison to Post's April forecast, soybean production is forecast to increase slightly for MY 2025/26. This is due to production increases in Poland and Italy. The production increases in these two Member States exceed downward production revisions in Romania. Forecasted harvested area remains largely unchanged at the EU level since the last forecast.

EU soybean exports are revised upwards from the Annual Report due to higher forecasted production. However, exports remain far lower than imported quantities. EU soybean imports have been adjusted upwards from the Annual Report in anticipation of stockpiling before the implementation of the European Union Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) on December 30, 2025. EUDR would impose several strict traceability requirements on covered products, including soybeans but excluding rapeseed

and sunflower seed. For more information on EUDR please see the GAIN report: [European Institutions Finalize Deforestation-Free Supply Chain Regulation](#).¹

Post revises its 2025/26 crush forecast upwards due to increased anticipated supply. Crush forecasts for Spain, Greece, Italy and Portugal have been adjusted upwards since the Annual Report.

MY 2024/25

MY 2024/25 production has been adjusted slightly downward since our March estimate, based on historical data revisions by the Member States. Production numbers were adjusted downward for Italy, alongside slight increases in Romania and Slovakia. Additionally, estimated harvested soybean area was decreased due to updates in Italy and Romania. Post adjusted MY 2024/25 imports upwards, reflecting a reported increase in import volumes and to supplement lower domestic production. Post has revised crush upwards, due to higher supply associated with increased imports. No changes were made for food, feed, seed, and waste use.

Soybean Meal

Table 8: Soybean meal – Production, Supply and Distribution

Meal, Soybean Market Year Begins European Union	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	14500	14400	15000	15500	15300	15200
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.79	0.7896	0.79	0.7903	0.79	0.7895
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	473	473	871	938	1279	1096
Production (1000 MT)	11455	11370	11850	12250	12087	12000
MY Imports (1000 MT)	16537	16539	19900	19500	17100	17400
Total Supply (1000 MT)	28465	28382	32621	31588	30466	30496
MY Exports (1000 MT)	652	652	700	650	600	500
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	10	10	10	10	10	10
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	32	32	32	32	32	32
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	26900	26750	30600	30900	28800	28800
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	26942	26792	30642	29842	28842	28842
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	871	938	1279	1096	1024	1154
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	28465	28382	32621	31588	30466	30496
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

Post's soybean meal production forecast has been adjusted upwards in line with higher projected soybean supply and crush. Imports have also been revised higher compared to the April Annual Report due to increased demand in the poultry sector. Meal supply has increased in Spain, Romania, Poland,

¹ <https://gain.fas.usda.gov/#/>

Portugal, Italy, Greece, and France, driven largely by consumption in the animal feed sector and the comparative advantage of soybean meal versus other animal feed ingredients. Feed demand for soybean meal has faced upward pressure from, among other factors, the imposition of EU import duties on Chinese Lysine. Lysine is a key component of animal feed formulations but can be partially substituted by increasing the proportion of soybean meal mixed into feed. Exports remain unchanged.

MY 2024/25

Meal production has been revised slightly higher following upward adjustments to MY 2024/25 soybean supply. Estimated imports have been revised almost 15 percent higher compared to Post’s spring numbers due to stockpiling triggered by the initial December 2024 implementation date for EUDR and the expanding poultry sector, which benefits from strong internal demand, growing exports, and fewer HPAI outbreaks. In Czechia, the Netherlands, Portugal, Romania, Poland, and France, soybean meal supply was increased due to higher imports. These imports were triggered by low availability of wheat for livestock consumption, following wheat production declines in MY 2024/25. Soybean meal exports are forecast to remain unchanged.

Soybean Oil

Table 9: Soybean oil – Production, Supply and Distribution

Oil, Soybean Market Year Begins European Union	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	14500	14400	15000	15500	15300	15200
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.19	0.1875	0.19	0.1871	0.19	0.1849
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	572	572	621	421	566	476
Production (1000 MT)	2755	2700	2850	2900	2907	2810
MY Imports (1000 MT)	586	592	650	590	650	500
Total Supply (1000 MT)	3913	3864	4121	3911	4123	3786
MY Exports (1000 MT)	662	663	900	830	850	780
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1150	1460	1200	1250	1250	1295
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1425	1270	1400	1300	1400	1255
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	55	50	55	55	55	55
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2630	2780	2655	2605	2705	2605
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	621	421	566	476	568	401
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	3913	3864	4121	3911	4123	3786
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

Post’s MY 2025/26 soybean oil production forecast has been revised upwards from the Annual Report due to adjustment increases in soybean supply and crush. Imports have only been slightly increased, while exports have been raised significantly by 7 percent for MY 2025/26. This revision is caused by

adjusted higher production and crush. Excess soybean oil is generally exported. Soybean oil used for industrial purposes was slightly increased due to higher use of soybean oil for biodiesel production in Bulgaria and Spain. According to local industry sources, Bulgarian biodiesel producers will most likely switch to soybean oil due to the high price of sunflower oil.

MY 2024/25

For MY 2024/25, soybean oil production was revised upwards due to higher total soybean supply and crush. Exports and imports both have marginally increased reflecting most recent trade data. Stocks were also revised and are higher than previously estimated due to preliminary EUDR stockpiling.

3. Rapeseed Complex

PSDs have been revised according to the most recent data available from Trade Data Monitor (April 2025) and Eurostat. Recent harvest and crush estimates are from producing countries.

Rapeseed Seed

Table 10: Oilseed, Rapeseed – Production, Supply, Distribution

Oilseed, Rapeseed Market Year Begins	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Jul 2023		Jul 2024		Jul 2025	
European Union	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	6400	0	6500	0	6500	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	6269	6263	5700	5700	5980	5960
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	1734	1734	1954	1600	1915	930
Production (1000 MT)	20447	20403	16861	16935	19650	19350
MY Imports (1000 MT)	5457	5457	7600	6495	5700	5800
Total Supply (1000 MT)	27638	27594	26415	25030	27265	26080
MY Exports (1000 MT)	534	534	400	350	350	470
Crush (1000 MT)	24400	24900	23450	23350	24300	23950
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	750	560	650	400	650	530
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	25150	25460	24100	23750	24950	24480
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	1954	1600	1915	930	1965	1130
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	27638	27594	26415	25030	27265	26080
Yield (MT/HA)	3.2616	3.2577	2.9581	2.9711	3.286	20.8065
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

EU rapeseed production levels are expected to recover from the very low levels seen in MY 2024/25. Forecasted rapeseed production has been revised upward since Post’s April report due to promising

early harvest information. Production forecasts for several Member States have been increased from the Annual Report. France and Poland report slight upward adjustments, while Bulgaria reports significantly higher production (over 7 percent). In Romania, a record harvest is forecast for MY 2025/26 and production has been revised upward eight percent. Post revises production for Czechia, Hungary, and Slovakia down due to unfavorable weather and drought.

MY 2025/26 crush is anticipated to increase due to higher rapeseed production and better crush margins as rapeseed prices decline in line with a better expected harvest. The EU is still expected to remain below its maximum crushing capacity. Forecasted crush and meal production have consequently been adjusted upward, especially in Bulgaria where advantageous rapeseed crushing margins prompted many crushers to switch from sunflower to rapeseed. Crush forecasts for Poland and Romania are also revised up due to anticipated higher production.

MY 2024/25

Production has been revised up, reflecting historical data adjustments by Member States. In France and Hungary, production was adjusted upwards. Slight decreases were noted in Greece, Czechia, and Bulgaria. Crushing increased in Bulgaria for MY 2024/25 due to expansion of crushing facilities for the production of biodiesel. Additionally, some crushers switched from sunflower to rapeseed due to better crush margins for rapeseed.

Rapeseed Meal

Table 11: Meal, Rapeseed – Production, Supply, Distribution

Meal, Rapeseed Market Year Begins	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Jul 2023		Jul 2024		Jul 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
European Union						
Crush (1000 MT)	24400	24900	23450	23350	24300	23950
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.57	0.5733	0.57	0.5717	0.57	0.5716
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	431	431	393	755	435	405
Production (1000 MT)	13908	14276	13367	13350	13851	13690
MY Imports (1000 MT)	823	823	375	540	800	710
Total Supply (1000 MT)	15162	15530	14135	14645	15086	14805
MY Exports (1000 MT)	869	875	900	840	700	750
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	13900	13900	12800	13400	13900	13500
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	13900	13900	12800	13400	13900	13500
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	393	755	435	405	486	555
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	15162	15530	14135	14645	15086	14805
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

Rapeseed meal production is expected to increase alongside higher rapeseed production. Post revises imports down by 5 percent as higher domestic production reduces the need to supplement supply through trade.

MY 2024/25

Post revises MY 2024/25 EU crush upwards following higher crushing levels in Bulgaria due to better crush margins for rapeseed than for sunflower seed. Additionally, the production of rapeseed meal was increased in Poland. In Romania and Lithuania, crush (and thus the production of rapeseed meal), is adjusted downwards. Imports are forecast to be slightly lower than originally estimated as higher domestic production accommodates increased demand.

Rapeseed Oil

Table 12: Oil, Rapeseed – Production, Supply, Distribution

Oil, Rapeseed Market Year Begins European Union	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Jul 2023		Jul 2024		Jul 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	24400	24900	23450	23350	24300	23950
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.42	0.4217	0.42	0.4206	0.42	0.4217
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	291	291	305	363	254	313
Production (1000 MT)	10248	10500	9849	9820	10206	10100
MY Imports (1000 MT)	463	463	300	300	400	280
Total Supply (1000 MT)	11002	11254	10454	10483	10860	10693
MY Exports (1000 MT)	747	746	600	750	700	750
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	7050	7200	6750	6575	6900	6750
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2850	2900	2800	2800	2950	2800
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	50	45	50	45	50	45
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	9950	10145	9600	9420	9900	9595
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	305	363	254	313	260	348
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	11002	11254	10454	10483	10860	10693
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

MY 2025/26 oil production has been adjusted higher due to anticipated increases in rapeseed production. Rapeseed oil is generally expected to become more attractive for biofuels, as other feedstock, such as soybean oil, becomes less attractive due to EUDR. Due to forecasted higher domestic production, imports are expected to decrease. Additionally, Canadian oil may be directed to the U.S. market following a change in U.S. biodiesel tax credit policy under the “One, Big, Beautiful Bill” which incentivizes Canadian rapeseed to be used in the U.S. energy market.

MY 2024/25

Due to increased production in some Member States (see rapeseed section) and higher crush, the amount of produced rapeseed oil has also been increased since the last estimate was published. Post has also revised its import estimate downwards, as higher domestic production leaves less room for foreign imports.

4. Sunflower Complex

PSDs have been revised according to the most recent data available from Trade Data Monitor (May 2025), Eurostat and EU Customs data (available until June 29). Recent harvest and crush estimates are from producing countries.

Sunflower Seeds

Table 13: Oilseed, Sunflowerseed – Production, Supply and Distribution

Oilseed, Sunflowerseed	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
European Union	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	5200	5200	4905	4870	5000	4780
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	4689	4700	4863	4820	4750	4780
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	381	381	596	538	443	433
Production (1000 MT)	10084	10100	8532	8750	9500	9400
MY Imports (1000 MT)	828	828	600	600	500	700
Total Supply (1000 MT)	11293	11309	9728	9888	10443	10533
MY Exports (1000 MT)	447	446	750	630	400	400
Crush (1000 MT)	9200	9300	7500	7800	8500	8700
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	515	515	515	515	515	515
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	535	510	520	510	535	510
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	10250	10325	8535	8825	9550	9725
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	596	538	443	433	493	408
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	11293	11309	9728	9888	10443	10533
Yield (MT/HA)	2.1506	2.1489	1.7545	1.8154	2	1.9665
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

Area planted under sunflower in the EU decreased by 2 percent in MY 2025/26 compared to MY 2024/25 due to larger area planted under winter grains and oilseeds (rapeseed) which left less available area for spring crops. Area planted declined mainly in Romania and Spain, followed distantly by France and Germany. In Romania, the sunflower area dropped by 7.5 percent due to the rapeseed area expansion. Some farmers report having to replant sunflower in fields affected by insects. In France, sunflower area has been declining for the last three years. In Spain, sunflower is replaced by winter crops on dry land or by corn on irrigated land.

The area decline exceeded the expansion reported in Bulgaria and Hungary, followed by smaller growth in Slovakia and Czechia. The growth in these countries was due to lower production costs/higher profitability of sunflower compared to alternative crops (lower planting seed prices and fertilization requirements compared to corn at times of expensive inputs) and better drought and heat resilience relative to corn. In Hungary, sunflower area increased at the expense of rapeseed. Additionally, the producer price of sunflower seeds for crushing was 68 percent higher in February 2025 compared to the corresponding period in 2024. In Bulgaria, record low sunflower crop in MY 2024/25 also increased producer prices above the levels seen in the previous season which motivated farmers to expand area due to favorable crush demand. In February-March when farmers make their final planting decisions, sunflower prices were about 45 percent higher than a year ago.

The weather conditions for sunflower development have been generally favorable this spring in most EU countries, however, recent summer heat and drought waves in Romania, Bulgaria, Hungary (especially eastern Hungary) and France threaten to reverse the initial positive outlook for yields. In France, optimism following the flowering period has diminished. High temperatures and lack of precipitation in the last weeks of June and in July have raised concerns among producers. In Hungary, sunflower germination did not develop well, the fields were in poorer condition than usual as the cold weather in May delayed initial crop development, and the period of extreme heat and prolonged drought at the end of June damaged farmers' yield expectations. In Bulgaria and Romania, the spring months brought abundant rains, particularly in May. However, above-average temperatures and dryness in June and July quickly wiped part of the yield potential leading to concerns among farmers. The most affected areas are south-western and south-eastern regions of Romania and north-western Bulgaria. Current satellite images indicate alarming droughts in France, Hungary, large parts of Romania, Bulgaria and some parts of Spain. The most important development stages such as flowering, pollination and filling in July occurred in extreme heat stress and dry conditions, dramatically reducing yields. In Spain, initially optimistic yields expectations resulting from ample spring precipitation have reversed as summer drought conditions push down anticipated yields. Andalusia was affected by spring precipitation delaying plantings and excessive heat while Castile and Leon showed excellent condition. However, early summer brought high temperatures and dryness in these regions as well.

Based on the above considerations, Post has revised yield estimates down for most major EU producers. Average EU yield is currently estimated at 1.97 MT/HA or 9 percent above the last season but still below the previous estimate (April) and below that in MY 2023/24 (2.15 MT/HA). Production is forecast to partially recover in Romania, Bulgaria, Hungary, and France, followed by smaller growth in Slovakia, Austria, and Czechia while a reduction is projected in Croatia and Germany. Overall, EU production is forecast to rebound in MY 2025/26 year-on-year and grow to 9.4 MMT, or by 7.4 percent compared to the record poor crop in MY 2024/25 but to be below Post's prior forecast of 10.0 MMT.

Despite expected better domestic supplies, current projections are for slightly higher imports compared to MY 2024/25 due to anticipated attractive crush margins and favorable crush demand in the EU.

Exports are expected to decrease from MY 2024/25 despite better availability and likely weaker competition from Ukraine in traditional export markets as high domestic demand consumes exportable supplies.

Crush demand is forecast to be strong based on currently projected crush margins and more favorable vegetable oil prices. Sunflower will compete mainly with rapeseed in terms of margins. Expected growth in consumer and industrial demand for sunflower oil is due to softening prices. Sunflower meal remains an attractive option or substitute in animal feed rations, especially in Hungary, Romania and Bulgaria, where it continues to see solid demand. Sunflower demand may be further supported by the introduction of EUDR in December 2025, as both rapeseed and sunflower seed are not affected by the traceability requirements for soy. Hungary, France, Romania, and Bulgaria forecast a significant increase in crush, followed by Italy and Germany. Spain is the only country which expects a small decline. This will likely drive EU processing at or above 8.7 MMT or 11 percent more than in MY 2024/25 although still under the level seen two years ago.

Ending stocks in MY 2025/26 are projected to decline due to increased domestic use.

MY 2024/25

EU area harvested, and production have been revised based on the latest data from Member States. MY 2024/25 production declined significantly, due to record-low average yields of 1.81 MT/HA caused by summer heat waves and drought in leading producer countries. Production losses associated with lower yields more than offset year-on-year increases in area harvested.

Imports of sunflower seeds are estimated to decline by over 25 percent from MY 2023/24, based on the latest trade data (TDM data from October 2024 through May 2025, and EU Customs data between July 2024 and end-June 2025). The main reason leading to lower imports was lower EU crush demand due to unattractive margins. Exports from Ukraine were weak since the Ukrainian processing industry increased its crush lowering exportable surpluses, thus Moldova and Argentina (in the second half of

MY) were the main sources of imports. Major EU importers have been Bulgaria, Romania, France, and Spain.

EU exports of sunflower seeds are estimated to grow by over 40 percent versus MY 2023/24 due to favorable export demand to Türkiye that have accounted for about 60 percent of total exports to date (EU Customs data). The top EU exporters were Bulgaria and Romania. Türkiye introduced a trade regime favoring imports in order to compensate for its lower crop. This development triggered a higher than initially anticipated export volume from Bulgaria and Romania at the expense of crush.

In line with earlier expectations, EU crush demand has not been favorable due to lower availability of sunflower seeds and poor crush margins compared to rapeseed and soybeans. Crush is estimated to decline by over 15 percent from MY 2023/24. Demand for sunflower oil faced competition from rapeseed oil and more price-competitive olive oil. The use of sunflower meal also decreased due to poor price competitiveness versus rival meals, especially soybean meal.

A decrease in crush compared to MY 2023/24 is expected in Bulgaria, France, Romania, Hungary, Spain, Italy, and Portugal while the Netherlands, Germany, Austria, and Greece anticipate similar processing levels year-on-year. In Romania and Bulgaria crushers could not source competitive sunflower seeds from Ukraine as many of these seeds were crushed domestically in Ukraine. In Spain, crush was reduced as imports of sunflower oil from Ukraine were readily available and olive oil production reverted to normal levels. Current industry data (FedOil, from October 2024 through June 2025) indicates a 4 percent increase in crush over the first quarter of the MY (October-December 2024) compared to a year ago but 28 percent lower crush in January-June 2025, resulting in an 18 percent decline in October 2024-June 2025 period.

Ending stocks are 20 percent lower than the year before due to lower available supplies, supporting elevated prices.

Sunflower Meal

Table 14: Oilseed, Sunflowerseed Meal – Production, Supply and Distribution

Meal, Sunflowerseed	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
European Union	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	9200	9300	7500	7800	8500	8700
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.5405	0.5366	0.5405	0.541	0.5421	0.5402
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	311	311	424	441	368	281
Production (1000 MT)	4973	4990	4054	4220	4608	4700
MY Imports (1000 MT)	3156	3156	2500	2530	2500	2600
Total Supply (1000 MT)	8440	8457	6978	7191	7476	7581
MY Exports (1000 MT)	956	956	600	500	900	810
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	60	60	60	60	60	60
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	7000	7000	5950	6350	6100	6500
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	7060	7060	6010	6410	6160	6560
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	424	441	368	281	416	211
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	8440	8457	6978	7191	7476	7581
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

Projected growth in crush is expected to translate into higher output of sunflower meal with estimated production at 4.7 MMT, 11 percent more than MY 2024/25. Leading the growth in meal output are Romania, Hungary, Bulgaria, France, and Italy while France, Spain, Belgium, and Germany expect small declines.

Larger output is likely to encourage a recovery in consumption and exports. Consumption of meal is projected to grow by 2.4 percent compared to MY 2024/25. This is based on the currently expected sunflower meal price ratio versus rival meals which shows better price competitiveness at the end of MY 2024/25 and in the first quarter of MY 2025/26. Countries that project higher meal consumption are Hungary, France, Italy, and Romania while Spain, the Netherlands and Poland forecast a decline.

It is believed that better domestic supply is not likely to result in lower imports. Imports from Ukraine might be enhanced due to expected good crush leading to higher and more price competitive meal (and oil) export availabilities. Imports of sunflower processed products from Ukraine are not subject to any

EU limitations such as TRQs although separate member-states may still apply temporary limitations (Romania). This is believed to lead to an increase in imports to complement EU consumption demand. Exports of sunflower meal are projected to recover from the current low season to a more traditional level, however, it may face stronger competition from Ukraine and other Black Sea suppliers limiting its growth.

MY 2024/25

EU sunflower meal output is adjusted down in line with lower crush. Bulgaria, France, Spain, Romania, Hungary, Italy, and Poland estimate lower production, while the output is stable in the Netherlands, Greece, and Portugal. As a result, meal production in MY 2024/25 is estimated to be 15 percent below the level of the previous season.

MY 2024/25 demand for sunflower meal has been weak due to an overall drop in feed/animal consumption in the EU and lack of competitiveness for sunflower meal versus rival meals and especially soybean meal. This decreased its incorporation in feed. Countries estimating a decline in consumption are Italy, Poland, Spain, Germany, Romania, Bulgaria, Portugal, and Denmark; stagnant use is seen in Belgium, Greece, Austria, Croatia, and Slovenia while France, Hungary, and Ireland estimate a small growth. Overall, this is expected to result in 9 percent lower EU consumption compared to a year ago.

Due to weaker feed demand, EU imports of sunflower meal have decreased. The current import estimate is for a 20 percent decline compared to MY 2023/24 and is based on the latest EU Customs and TDM data. The EU has imported sunflower meal mainly from Ukraine (62 percent) and Argentina (29 percent), with EU imports concentrated in the Netherlands, France, Poland, Italy and Spain. Exports have been revised significantly downward, declining by over 40 percent from the previous season due to low supply and poor export competitiveness. Main destinations were the United Kingdom (27 percent), Morocco, and Norway (19 percent share each). The main EU exporters were Romania, the Netherlands, and Germany.

Sunflower Oil

Table 15: Oilseed, Sunflowerseed Oil – Production, Supply and Distribution

Oil, Sunflowerseed	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
European Union	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	9200	9300	7500	7800	8500	8700
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.4225	0.4237	0.4225	0.4231	0.4226	0.423
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	292	292	741	704	422	441
Production (1000 MT)	3887	3940	3169	3300	3592	3680
MY Imports (1000 MT)	2965	2965	2325	2350	2200	2350
Total Supply (1000 MT)	7144	7197	6235	6354	6214	6471
MY Exports (1000 MT)	990	990	650	650	700	700
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	550	550	500	550	500	550
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	4850	4940	4650	4700	4640	4850
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	13	13	13	13	13	13
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	5413	5503	5163	5263	5153	5413
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	741	704	422	441	361	358
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	7144	7197	6235	6354	6214	6471
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Source: FAS EU, TDM, Eurostat

MY 2025/26

EU sunflower oil output is projected to grow by 11.5 percent from MY 2024/25 due to an expected increase in crush. Production growth is anticipated in Romania, Hungary, Bulgaria and France, followed by Italy, and this exceeds projected declines in Spain.

It is believed that better domestic supply may not necessarily result in lower imports. Black Sea suppliers expect higher crush, and improved, price competitive export potential which may benefit the EU consumers. Imports are forecast to be stable at around 2.3 to 2.4 MMT to support a recovery in both EU exports and domestic consumption. In Romania, because of free-of-licensing status and its competitiveness, sunflower oil may be imported from Ukraine although this may have a negative impact on local crush margins. EU exports are forecast to increase by about 8 percent from MY 2024/25. EU export volumes, however, will be challenged by Ukrainian export shipments to Asia (especially to India) and the Middle East.

Consumption of sunflower oil is projected to rebound driven by anticipated lower prices for consumers, higher demand by the food industry, and thriving tourism and travel. The estimate is for 4.85 MMT or three percent growth over MY 2024/25. All Member States anticipate stable and/or higher use led by France, Poland and Romania. At the same time, sunflower oil will face more competition from rapeseed and olive oils which are projected to be in better supply and at lower prices than in the current MY.

MY 2024/25

Production of sunflower oil is estimated 16 percent lower than in MY 2023/24 due to lower crush. France, Spain, Bulgaria, Romania, and Hungary report the sharpest declines, followed by Portugal, Poland, and Croatia. Countries seeing stable production include the Netherlands, Germany, Austria, Czechia and Greece.

Imports of sunflower oil are projected about 20 percent lower compared to a year earlier. The estimate is based on the latest EU Customs and TDM data. Demand has been weaker due to competition with olive oil and elevating prices. In the first quarter of MY 2024/25, the average import price was at \$1,132.55/MT versus \$923.88/MT a year ago (23 percent higher); in the second quarter it was at \$1,241.06/MT compared to \$896.3/MT (39 percent higher), and in May (the latest available data in TDM), the import price was at \$1,245.35/MT or 34 percent more than in May 2024 (\$926.91). The main supplier of sunflower oil remained Ukraine (96 percent), with leading importing countries including Spain, Italy, the Netherlands, France, Bulgaria and Slovenia.

EU consumption of sunflower oil is estimated to drop by 5 percent from MY 2023/24.

France, Belgium, Czechia and Poland report lower food use; Germany, Romania, Hungary, Bulgaria, the Netherlands, Austria, Denmark, Ireland, Greece, Croatia, Sweden and Slovenia see flat consumption while marginal growth is estimated in Spain, Italy, Portugal, and Slovakia.

Industrial use is estimated to be lower than in MY 2023/24, mainly due to higher prices, increased competition from other oils (rapeseed oil), as well as waste feedstocks, e.g., recycled/used cooking oils and animal fats.

Exports are estimated to decline by 34 percent from MY 2023/24 due to low domestic production. The main export destinations were the United Kingdom (26 percent) and India (10 percent) with France, Bulgaria and Spain as major exporters, followed by the Netherlands and Finland. Some exports also include transit shipments and re-exports of Ukrainian oil refined by EU refiners.

5. Policy

Common Agricultural Policy (CAP)

On May 14, 2025, the European Commission published a [proposal](#)² to simplify the CAP. The proposed measures target the administrative burden, controls, implementation of the CAP as well as CAP crisis management tools. Notably, the proposal simplifies environmental requirements (GAECs for good agro-environmental conditions) linked to eco-payments for farmers. The proposal is now going through the EU legislative process.

Trade

EU Retaliatory Tariffs

On July 27, 2025, United States President Trump and European Commission President von der Leyen announced a political agreement on tariffs and trade to rebalance the economic relationship between the world's two largest economies. For more information on the agreement, please refer to the [White House Fact Sheet](#)³ and the [European Commission's explanatory webpage](#).⁴ To ensure effective implementation of the political agreement, the European Union published [Implementing Regulation 2025/1727](#)⁵ suspending its retaliatory tariffs on certain U.S. products imposed by [Implementing Regulation 2025/1564](#).⁶

Related Reports

For related reports please search the USDA/FAS GAIN database:

<https://gain.fas.usda.gov/Pages/Default.aspx>

Attachments:

No Attachments.

² https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/overview-vision-agriculture-food/eu-actions-address-farmers-concerns_en

³ <https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2025/07/fact-sheet-the-united-states-and-european-union-reach-massive-trade-deal/>

⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/qanda_25_1930

⁵ https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:L_202501727

⁶ https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:L_202501564